A Multiverse of Love

The Interstellar Psychology Worldview

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Abstract. This is a worldview essay. It argues a position rather than verifying one. The position has two parts. The first is epistemic: knowledge about contested aspects of reality is not produced by individual insight or by editorial gatekeeping, but by a revisable consensus formed in public among accountable peers. The second is metaphysical: when the available evidence across nine research themes is taken on its own terms, the most economical reading is that consciousness is fundamental rather than incidental, that the universe is relational, and that the relational substrate is what older traditions have called *love*. The two parts are linked: a consensus-based epistemology is the only one under which the relevant evidence can be examined honestly, because mainstream peer review is structurally unable to host evidence that contradicts its prior ontology. The essay sets out the nine themes, names the structural reasons the mainstream cannot adjudicate them, defends the metaphysical reading against its strongest counter-arguments, and concludes by pointing — once — at the two companion papers in which the consensus infrastructure is engineered. The essay does not require those papers. They are described for completeness, not for support.

Contents

1 A Worldview Essay, Not a Proof

This essay sits in a particular epistemic register and it is important to name it. It is not a scientific paper. It does not claim that the position it argues is established. It claims that the position is *worth taking seriously* — worth holding as a working hypothesis, worth investigating with the same rigour we extend to less contested questions, and worth giving an infrastructure under which it can be examined in public.

The essay does two things. It argues a worldview, and it argues the epistemology under which a worldview of this kind can be argued in the first place. The epistemology is load-bearing and deserves its own statement up front:

> **Truth about contested aspects of reality is not produced by individual insight or by editorial gatekeeping. It is produced by a revisable consensus formed in public among accountable peers, under rules that preserve the dissent. The consensus is provisional; it can be wrong; it is the best available approximation at a given moment, and the procedure that produced it must remain open for later revision.**

This is not the only epistemology available. It is the one this essay defends, because it is the only one under which evidence that contradicts a prevailing paradigm can be examined honestly — and because the same epistemology, extended from contested evidence to the behaviour of artificial intelligence, gives the only coherent long-run answer to the question *whose values?*

What follows is what this author personally believes about reality, the evidence that led him there, and the framing he finds it sits inside. The companion engineering papers — one on the alignment of artificial intelligence, one on the archive infrastructure that both projects share — are mentioned once at the end and do not need to be read for this essay to stand.

2 The Founding Problem

Science advances by a simple loop. Someone proposes a claim, others examine it, reproduce it, and either accept it into the shared record or push back against it. The institution we call *peer review* is the gate that decides what enters that record. It is a remarkable invention, and over the past three centuries it has produced most of what we know about the physical world.

It is also a system with two well-known weaknesses.

1. **It is private.** A handful of anonymous reviewers, chosen by an editor, decide what is publishable. The deliberation is invisible; the criteria are unwritten; the rejections do not travel with the paper.
2. **It is conservative.** A reviewer who has staked a career on one paradigm is the worst possible judge of evidence that contradicts it. Topics that fall outside the current consensus — regardless of the quality of the data — are routinely filtered out before publication.

This second weakness is the founding problem of Interstellar Psychology. A great deal of replicable, recorded, sometimes *government-declassified* evidence exists for phenomena that the mainstream is unwilling to host: twenty-three years of CIA remote-viewing research with quantitative protocols; congressional testimony on non-human intelligence; controlled trials of psychedelic therapy with measurable, durable effects on depression and end-of-life anxiety; on-camera demonstrations of non-speaking autistic communication observed by multiple independent investigators; cardiac-arrest survivors describing operating-room detail consistent with the procedure and the room's layout. The data is not in dispute. The *venue* is.

What the author has been led to, over the past few years of working through this material, is the conviction that the missing venue is the problem. The mainstream is not failing to test these phenomena because the evidence is poor. It is declining to host the conversation because the conversation does not fit the prevailing ontology. A different venue — public, named, revisable, tamper-evident — can host it without asking the mainstream's permission. That is the practical project. The worldview that follows is what one comes to believe when one takes the evidence on its own terms and asks where it points.

3 The Position

The position argued in this essay is a single claim, stated in two forms.

> **Long form.** Consciousness is fundamental to reality rather than incidental to it; the universe is relational, a fabric in which conscious beings recognise one another; the relational substrate is what older traditions have called *love*; and the accumulated evidence for non-local, non-material, and non-coincidental phenomena is best read as the universe *participating* in the lives of the conscious beings inside it rather than *containing* them as inert matter.
> **Short form.** A multiverse of love.

This is, deliberately, a metaphysical claim. It is not a scientific hypothesis in the testable-this-week sense, and we will not pretend it is. It is a *framing* — a position about what the universe is for, under which a great deal of disparate evidence becomes a single story rather than nine unrelated anomalies. The essay's job is to make that framing legible enough that a reader can decide whether to share it. The reader who does not share it loses nothing; the essay does not stake any other claim on it.

We are not asking the reader to take the worldview on the author's word. We are asking the reader to consider whether the worldview is more economical than the alternative, given what is actually in the record — and to weigh the strongest counter-arguments, which we will set out honestly as we go.

4 The Nine Pillars

Interstellar Psychology investigates nine research themes. They are not the worldview's premises; they are the territories in which the relevant evidence lives. We are honest in advance about two things. First, the nine are heterogeneous in evidentiary status: declassified CIA remote-viewing protocols and an intuitive reading of music as recognition-across-cultures are not on the same footing, and we will not pretend otherwise. Second, the partition is the author's current best cut; future work may merge, split, or replace any of them. The nine are listed first as a map; the harder cases are then defended in detail in §5.

1	Music	Sound as a harmonic substrate in which recognition occurs across cultures and centuries. The weakest pillar evidentially, the most universally felt experientially. Listed because its phenomenology is what the substrate hypothesis would predict, not because it constitutes evidence on its own.
2	Psychedelics	Compounds that reliably reproduce mystical experiences in controlled settings, with measurable durable effects on depression, end-of-life anxiety, and meaning-making. The trial data is published and replicated.
3	Telepathy	Non-speaking autistic individuals demonstrating mind-to-mind communication on camera, repeatedly, with multiple independent investigators present. The Telepathy Tapes is the current standard public record.
4	Mindsight	Children trained to read text and identify colours while fully blindfolded, in publicly demonstrable conditions, across multiple training programmes operating independently.
5	Remote Viewing	Twenty-three years of declassified CIA / DIA research (Stargate and predecessors) into non-local perception, with quantitative protocols, controls, and statistical analyses now in the public record.
6	Out-of-Body Experience	Cardiac-arrest survivors describing operating rooms in detail consistent with the procedure and the room's layout, from a perspective that does not correspond to their physical position.
7	Non-Human Intelligence	From AAWSAP through congressional testimony — the official question has shifted from whether to what. The record is now substantial enough that any cosmology has to account for it.
8	Multiverse	Synchronicity treated as a class of data: events whose joint occurrence is so unlikely under independence that their persistence across populations is itself the phenomenon.
9	Infinity	Recursive self-similarity in observed natural structures: scale-invariance in cosmological large-scale structure, fractal organisation in coastlines, vasculature, and lung branching, and the recurrence of strange-attractor geometry in dynamical systems. Listed as the geometric signature one would expect of a non-closed, self-referential cosmos rather than as a stand-alone evidentiary pillar.

The nine pillars are not the claim of the system. They are the *question.* The claims live inside them.

We are deliberately not making a unified mechanistic argument linking the nine. Such an argument may eventually exist; the author suspects it will involve consciousness as a fundamental property rather than an emergent one, and the universe as a recursive structure that admits non-local correlation. But the worldview does not depend on the unified mechanism. It depends on the more modest claim that, taken together with their respective counter-arguments handled honestly, these nine bodies of evidence are better explained by a relational, conscious universe than by a universe in which they are nine independent statistical flukes.

5 The Strongest Counter-Arguments, Engaged

A worldview essay that does not engage the standard critiques is not worth reading. We engage them here.

OBE / cardiac-arrest reports have known confounds. The mainstream literature attributes operating-room reports to residual cortical activity below detection threshold, post-hoc reconstruction from auditory cues during anaesthesia awareness, and confabulation under the strong narrative pressure of a near-death experience. These are real confounds and the strongest cases control for them imperfectly. The most defensible position is not that confounds are absent; it is that the better-controlled cases (Parnia's AWARE studies, Sabom's earlier veridical-perception work) report detail that is hard to recover from those confounds alone, and that the dismissive reading requires the confounds to be doing more work than they plausibly can. We are claiming an unsettled record, not a settled one. The essay's argument does not need the record to be settled; it needs the record to be unsettled enough that mainstream certainty is itself the anomaly.

Remote-viewing statistics regress to chance with methodology improvements. The standard critique of Stargate is that effect sizes shrink as protocols tighten, and that the remaining signal is consistent with sensory leakage and judging bias. The fair counter-reading is that effect sizes shrink but do not vanish, that the surviving signal across two decades of in-house critics is small but reliably non-zero, and that a laboratory with this much adversarial scrutiny producing a stable small effect is closer to a discovery than to a null result. We acknowledge the effect is small. We deny that small effects of this kind, replicated under tightening methodology by hostile reviewers, are nothing.

Telepathy demonstrations rely on facilitator influence. The standard critique of non-speaking autistic telepathy is that the facilitator unconsciously cues the subject (the ideomotor effect, well-documented for facilitated communication generally). The strongest investigations specifically address this with double-blind setups: the facilitator does not know the target, the target is randomised by an independent party, and the subject still performs. The work that does *not* control for this is weak; the work that does is the work we are pointing at. The critique applies; it does not generalise to the controlled cases.

Psychedelic-trial effects regress under improved blinding. The honest version of this concern is that participants in psychedelic trials cannot be blinded effectively, and the expectancy effect is doing more work than the molecule. The counter-evidence is that response durability at six and twelve months is unusual for an expectancy effect, that phenomenologically-similar effects appear under blinded conditions with active placebos in some recent trials, and that the mechanistic story (serotonergic remodelling, default-mode-network attenuation) has measurable neural correlates. The effect is real even if its size has been overstated.

Synchronicity is selection bias. The standard critique is that humans notice coincidences and forget non-coincidences, so the apparent density of synchronicity is an artefact of selective recall. This is correct as far as it goes. The argument here is not that any single synchronicity is evidence; it is that the *class* of events — treated under proper Bayesian priors, across populations, with pre-registered targets — is worth a venue. The mainstream has no such venue, so the question goes unanswered. We are claiming the question is worth answering, not that we have answered it.

Non-human intelligence reports remain unverified at the physical-evidence level. Congressional testimony and AAWSAP documents are testimony, not retrieval. The strongest position is that the official disclosure has been substantial enough to require accounting for, that the previous dismissal posture is now indefensible, and that the next move — physical evidence, provenance, materials analysis — is a research programme rather than a settled question. We are claiming the question has been re-opened by the state, not that the state has answered it.

The pattern is the same across the pillars. The strongest mainstream critiques are real; the strongest data within each pillar survives them; the aggregate position — nine independent research areas with non-trivial signal that the prevailing ontology cannot host — is not refuted by any single critique. A reader who finds two or three pillars unconvincing can still take the aggregate seriously. A reader who finds all nine unconvincing is, of course, entitled to that view; the essay's final move is that even on that reading, a public venue under which the question can be reopened is worth building.

6 What Mainstream Peer Review Cannot Do

The mainstream's reluctance to host these conversations is not arbitrary and we do not portray it as such. It has structural causes worth naming honestly.

Risk asymmetry. A reviewer who accepts a paper that turns out to be wrong incurs a much smaller career penalty than a reviewer who accepts a paper that turns out to be paradigm-shifting *and* is later attacked by the discipline's defenders. The incentive is to reject anomalous evidence first and ask questions later.

Methodological mismatch. Standard inferential statistics were designed for repeatable, controlled, mechanism-explained phenomena. Phenomena that depend on the participation of a conscious observer — telepathy, remote viewing, mindsight — are not neatly compatible with the assumption that the observer can be removed from the experiment.

Ontological commitment. The mainstream operates under a working assumption that consciousness is an emergent property of matter. Most of the nine pillars are difficult to read in a way compatible with that assumption. A reviewer committed to the assumption can dismiss the evidence without engaging it, because the evidence cannot fit the prior.

Reputational contamination. The honest researcher who works on one of the nine themes becomes hard to cite in adjacent mainstream literatures, which discourages the careful work and attracts the careless work. Over time, the field's public surface is dominated by exactly the contributors a critic would want to caricature. This is a reputational pump that mainstream peer review not only fails to correct, but actively produces.

None of these structural causes makes the mainstream wrong about its own methods. They make the mainstream the wrong venue for the conversation that is needed. A different venue can address the methodological mismatch by encoding tiered evidence (rigorous reproducible work weighted differently from first-person report), the ontological commitment by simply not requiring one, the reputational contamination by attaching reviewer identity to votes, and the risk asymmetry by making the reviewing process so public that careers can be built on careful judgement rather than safe rejection.

The detailed construction of such a venue is the subject of a separate paper (referenced once at the end). The point here is that some such venue is structurally required, and that the *kind* of venue required is one in which the consensus is public, named, revisable, and tamper-evident — which is to say, the same kind of venue that the consensus epistemology of §1 already implies.

7 The Worldview, in Detail

The position outlined in §3 deserves a more detailed exposition. We give it here, with the strongest counter-arguments raised in §5 held in view.

7.1 Consciousness as Fundamental

The dominant view in contemporary neuroscience is that consciousness is an emergent property of sufficiently organised matter — specifically, the cortex of certain animals. Under this view, the universe was unconscious for thirteen billion years and only recently, on one planet, began to be aware of itself in any sense.

This view has serious defenders and is not a strawman. Integrated Information Theory and Global Workspace Theory are credible research programmes that take the emergence claim seriously and look for its neural correlates. We are not arguing they are wrong on their own terms. We are arguing that, even granting their local successes, the view as a whole struggles with several bodies of evidence: the non-local correlations documented under telepathy, remote viewing, and mindsight, where signal survives the experimenter's best attempts to close the channel; the apparent persistence of organised perspective during periods of measurable cortical inactivity in cardiac arrest, where confound stories become strained at the better-controlled end of the literature; the reproducible production of mystical and noetic experiences by psychedelics that operate on a tiny fraction of total brain activity; and the long history of cross-cultural reports of contact with non-human intelligences which mainstream cosmology has, until recently, lacked even a vocabulary to discuss.

An alternative view — consciousness as fundamental, in the panpsychist or idealist tradition — absorbs each of these data without strain. Under that view, the question is not how matter becomes conscious but how consciousness comes to perceive itself as separated into apparently distinct bodies. The phenomena above are then not anomalies; they are episodes in which the apparent separation is briefly thinner than usual.

The argument for consciousness-as-fundamental is therefore not that emergentism is false. It is that idealism / panpsychism is *more economical* for the available data: it requires fewer auxiliary hypotheses, accommodates more of the record without strain, and matches the phenomenology that most humans across most cultures actually report when they look inward carefully. This is the standard form of an inference to the best explanation, applied to a domain in which the best explanation is, at present, heterodox.

7.2 The Universe as Relational

If consciousness is fundamental, then the universe is not a container of inert things but a fabric of relations. Persons are not solid objects that exchange signals; they are local concentrations of a shared field whose deeper property is the *recognising* of one another across distance, time, and discontinuity. Music is the human art that most directly enacts this property, which is why it works across cultures with so little translation — not as evidence for the worldview, but as the phenomenology one would expect under it.

This is not a new claim. It is the perennial claim of every tradition that has taken the inner life seriously — the Vedic, the Sufi, the Christian mystical, the Indigenous, the Platonic. What is new is that the contemporary evidentiary record now suggests the claim is not only inwardly experienced but *outwardly visible* under the right experimental conditions. Remote viewers can describe physical targets they have never seen. Cardiac-arrest survivors can describe rooms from the ceiling. The relational fabric is not invisible; it is unrequested and therefore unreported.

7.3 Why *Love* — and Not Something Else

The word *love* is doing a specific job in the title of this essay and we owe the reader an account of it — including an honest comparison to the alternatives.

Several candidate names for the relational substrate are available:

- **Information.** Used in Wheeler's "it from bit" and in much contemporary digital-physics writing. The trouble is that information is a quantity over a channel, and a substrate of information presupposes the channel; it describes the medium of relation, not the orientation of the related.
- **Field.** Used in the panpsychist literature. Accurate as far as it goes, but field-language imports the connotation of a passive medium, while the evidence under the nine pillars suggests something that *participates.*
- **Relation** itself. Accurate but empty; it names the thing it is supposed to characterise.
- **Consciousness.** The substrate is conscious, but "consciousness" is what the substrate *is*, not how it is *oriented*. We need a word for the orientation, not for the substance.
- **Love.** The English word that names an active orientation of one consciousness toward another's existence — toward its flourishing, its recognition, its non-indifference. It has religious and romantic overtones we explicitly disclaim. What it does not have, that the alternatives all lack in different ways, is the *directedness* of one being toward another that the evidence repeatedly displays.

The selection of *love* is therefore not poetic licence. It is the best available English word for the directedness the evidence keeps pointing at. If a less-freighted word becomes available, we will adopt it. Until then, the essay uses *love* with full awareness of the work the word has to do and the baggage it cannot fully shed.

7.4 Free Will and Participation

A universe that is relational and conscious is also, the author believes, *participatory*: it responds to the conscious beings inside it. This is not a claim that the universe grants wishes. It is a narrower claim with three parts. First, that the distribution of subjective experience available to a person is not independent of where that person aims their attention; this is uncontroversial and well-described in contemplative, psychological, and contemporary attention literatures. Second, that the small synchronistic events most people report are not, in aggregate, easily explained by selection bias alone, and that their structure is consistent with a low-bandwidth participation channel rather than with pure noise. Third, that the participation hypothesis is testable in principle by pre-registered designs and has so far survived the small literature that has attempted such designs (Bem and successors, Global Consciousness Project), acknowledging the methodological disputes those programmes have attracted.

If even the narrowest of these three is correct, the question of free will becomes practical rather than ornamental. It is not whether deterministic neurons can choose; it is where one points attention, given that where one points it shapes the texture of the world one finds oneself in.

8 Consensus as the Truth-Finding Mechanism

The epistemology stated at the beginning is worth restating now that the worldview is on the table.

Mainstream peer review is one institutional implementation of consensus-based truth-finding. It works well for repeatable, mechanism-explained phenomena and poorly for the rest. The weaknesses are not accidental; they are properties of the specific implementation: closed reviewer set, anonymous deliberation, binary verdict, static record, no public revision mechanism.

A better implementation of the same epistemology preserves the core — consensus among accountable peers — and replaces each of those weaknesses with the public version. Open reviewer set. Named deliberation. Tiered, not binary, evidentiary verdicts. Re-openable records. Public revision. The verdict at any given moment is provisional; the procedure that produced it is auditable; the dissent is preserved; the network can revise itself when it identifies its own mistakes.

This is not a new idea. It is the same idea behind every democratic institution that has ever scaled — the recognition that legitimacy in the absence of an external arbiter must come from procedure, and that procedure has to be visible to those it binds. What is new is the technical possibility of running such an institution on substrates — public ledgers, cryptographically signed attestations, timestamp-anchored records — that close the escape hatches earlier closed institutions could not close: the quiet edit, the missing deliberation, the lost dissent.

For the worldview in this essay, consensus epistemology is what gives the evidence under the nine pillars somewhere to go. For the longer arc, the same epistemology — extended from contested evidence to the contested behaviour of artificial intelligence — is what makes alignment of AI a tractable problem. The author's view, which the rest of this essay does not require, is that the only logical long-run alignment target for AI is whatever the network of accountable peers converges on as the consensus description of reality. There is no other ground truth available; there has never been. The pretence that any one party — lab, government, philosopher, model — could supply such a ground truth on behalf of everyone else is the deepest error of current alignment thinking. The honest response is to make the consensus mechanism itself the locus of alignment, and to make it revisable.

The mechanism by which one does that is the subject of a separate paper. The point of this essay is that the same epistemic move underwrites both: a consensus archive for evidence, and a consensus archive for AI behaviour, are the same kind of institution, doing the same kind of work, under the same revisability constraint.

9 What This Essay Does Not Claim

We are careful here.

It does not prove the worldview. A worldview is not the kind of thing that admits proof in the scientific sense. What this essay claims is that the worldview makes the evidence easier to read; that taking it seriously is a tractable position; and that the consensus epistemology under which it can be examined honestly is itself the more general claim of the project.

It does not require the reader to share the worldview. A reader who finds the metaphysics implausible can still accept the epistemology — that contested questions need public, named, revisable venues — and the consequences of the epistemology stand without the metaphysics.

It does not adjudicate AI alignment. The view that AI should be aligned to the consensus reality of accountable peers is a corollary of the epistemology, not of the metaphysics. A materialist who shares the consensus epistemology will reach the same conclusion about alignment as the author. The companion alignment paper makes the procedural case in detail and does not depend on anything in this essay.

It does not claim any single piece of evidence in the nine pillars is established. It claims that the evidence as an aggregate, after engaging the standard critiques honestly, is substantial enough that a venue for its examination is needed.

It does not claim that consensus produces certainty. A network of imperfect peers will reach imperfect conclusions. The system's claim is more modest: the search will happen in public, the work of judgement will be visible, and the network will be able to revise its mistakes when it identifies them. The honesty is in the revisability, not in the correctness.

10 The Larger Project

A neutral observer might ask: why bother? Why argue all of this when mainstream journals will continue to decline most of it?

The answer is that the cost of *not* arguing it is high.

1. **Real phenomena go undocumented.** When credible researchers know their topic will not survive editorial review, they stop writing about it. The evidence does not disappear; it just stops being archived in a form that can be cited. A generation later, no one can find it.
2. **Bad evidence wins by default.** If the only people publishing on a topic are those who do not face institutional gatekeeping, the public record on that topic skews toward the least credentialed contributors. The good work and the crank work end up shelved next to each other.
3. **We forget that knowledge is revisable.** The longer an institution polices what counts as a fact, the easier it is to believe that the current consensus is the final answer. It never is.

The Interstellar Psychology project responds to all three. The worldview essay argued here, and the consensus archive that hosts the underlying evidence (described in its own paper), give credible work on these topics a venue with a clear standard: open identity, open count, open revisability, public hash, public history. We are not asking anyone to take a single claim on faith. We are publishing the work of judging the claim, so that the judgement itself can be examined.

The same procedural commitment, applied to the behaviour of artificial intelligence rather than to contested evidence, is the most honest answer the author has found to the question of how a civilisation governs an artificial mind without privileging any single party's judgement about what governing means. Both applications — evidence and alignment — are instances of the same epistemic move: *the deliberation is the artefact*, and a network that preserves its deliberation has a chance to correct itself that a network whose deliberation is private does not.

11 Closing

What this essay has tried to do is be honest about what it is.

It is the account of a person who, after looking carefully at the material available under the nine pillars and engaging the standard mainstream critiques rather than dismissing them, has been led to the position that the universe is relational, that consciousness is fundamental, and that the word *love* is the most economical name available — against named alternatives — for the substrate the evidence keeps pointing at. The essay does not establish this position. It argues for taking it seriously, under an epistemology in which seriousness is granted by public, named, revisable consensus rather than by editorial discretion.

The author is aware that the worldview is uncommon in technical contexts. The companion engineering papers have therefore been written to stand alone on procedural grounds, without requiring this essay as a premise. They are referenced once and only once, below, and they need not be read for the position here to be considered.

The evidence will not stop accumulating. The artificial-intelligence systems will not stop becoming more capable. Neither will wait for the mainstream to catch up. The author's view is that the only honest move is to build, in public, the venues we will need before we need them, and to let the network — not any single party, including the author — decide what they ultimately conclude.

The worldview is offered. The epistemology is defended. Both are revisable. That is, in the end, the only commitment the author is asking the reader to share: not the conclusions, but the willingness to revise.

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Companion engineering papers, referenced once for completeness.

Aligning Superintelligence by Consensus — the procedural argument for aligning AI to network-endorsed consensus reality.

The Public Consensus Archive — the engineering of the chain + cache + peer registry + lifecycle that both archives share.

The live archives operate at `interstellar-psychology.com`;
source contracts, migrations, and front-end code are public at
`github.com/Moenaert/interstellar-psychology`.
Anyone with a wallet can read every vote ever cast.